

Critical question 1:

About halfway through reading, it dawned on me: Do the rigid rules and standards of SAE actually get in the way of people being able to understand it? By trying to be "neutral" is it actually helping no one?

Critical question 2:

Throughout the text, Young mentions that people are made to believe that the way they talk at home should be totally separate than the way they communicate in professional settings. Those who teach this rhetoric aim to suppress different cultural dialects, to instead conform to standard written English. My question is, what are the thought processes behind this thinking? What makes people want to conform to a singular way of communication; to reject all others as informal or beneath a certain level of professionalism?

Young's thesis in "Should Writers Use They Own English?" is that English dialects and slang is just as valuable and academically valid as standard written English. Young challenges the rhetoric of a *New York Times* opinion writer and cultural critic Stanley Fish through showing different scholarly and public figures using slang and vernacular in otherwise professional circumstances. Young challenges the idea of code switching, that people totally change the way they talk in different situations. Instead of switching, people code mesh and combine the different ways people talk. This linguistic diversity is something that needs to be used more and celebrated; not put aside for a singular, white, way of writing.

1. What did you learn about language and writing from this text? How has your perception of "good English" been challenged or changed?

I learned that standard written English is not a requirement in created a good-looking, well research, understandable paper. After the initial shock of realizing the text wasn't written in an uptight fashion, I found that the paper was enjoyable to read. I also found the vocabulary to be more engaging than texts I've read that conform to standard written English. It was more relatable, even if I don't write, and won't use Young's particular writing style.

2. How do you use language differently depending on your audience and circumstance? Even if you only speak English, think about the different kinds of English you speak (dialect, slang, word choice).

When I write for my classes, I try and keep an extra good look at what I'm writing. If I don't, I feel my writing looks too messy to be acceptable. Even for texting or messages, I at least try to keep good capitalization and punctuation. The pattern here is that if I have to use some sort of keyboard, I pay extra good attention to my language and formatting. In public situations, I remove vocabulary from my language that could be offensive. Even though me or my friend group aren't bothered by certain vulgarities, I still want to respect everyone's grandma. But overall, I like sounding friendly, and as I alluded to before, I'm not a big fan of uptight language especially when it impedes my understanding.

3. How might you work this text into your self-portrait and reflection on your writing influences and language background?

The main thing is that the text has made me more comfortable with just writing and not being too bothered with the language I use. I can show how language not written in standard written English can be a valid way to communicate in professional settings. But the text has made me think about how the way I talk to people is the way I try and talk on the page. Overly thought out, I might have a lot to say, but I won't bother because I don't want to sound stupid or overly excited. There's also definitely a fear of me giving my thoughts on something that I have no authority in. Young's work has gotten me to be more comfortable with just saying what would make me more coherent, instead of trying to find the most academic way to phrase my thoughts.